

# Which Austin 311 services got slower?

Austin 311 | 2.5M service requests | 2014-2026 | Data: data.austintexas.gov

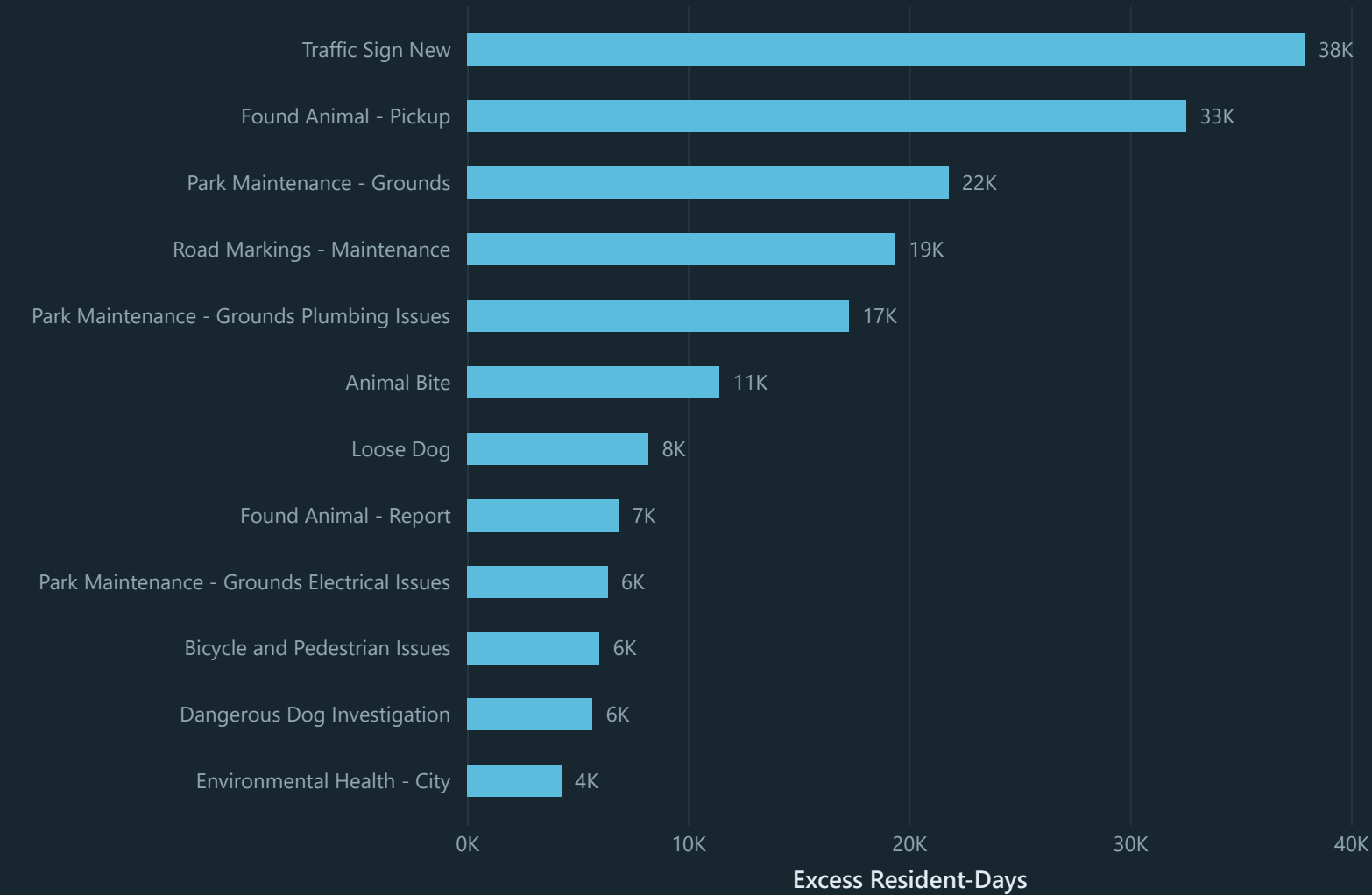
Requests in cohort

2.34M

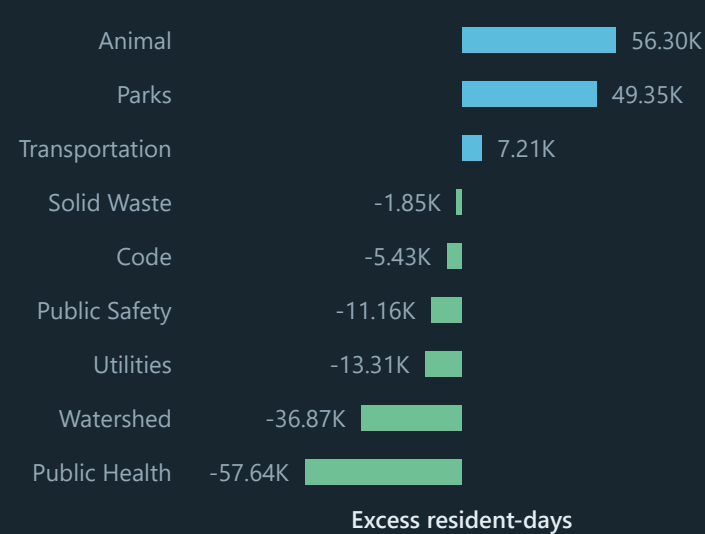
Excess Resident-Days

178K

## Excess resident-days by service



## Excess wait by department (left of zero = improved)



## Where the excess sits

Animal services are the largest single source of excess wait (56.3K resident-days), driven by the 2024 Animal Center capacity crisis. Parks maintenance is second at 49.4K, spread across four sub-services running 3–12 times slower than their own baseline. The single worst service is Traffic Sign New (+13 days).

# How has resolution time moved, month by month?

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Department

All

Service

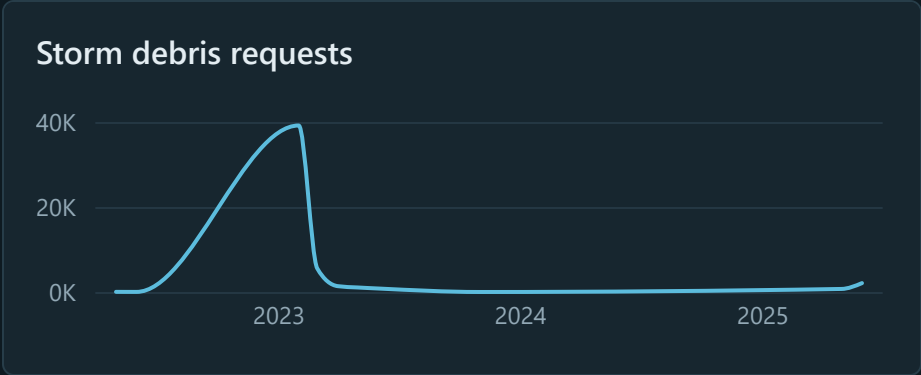
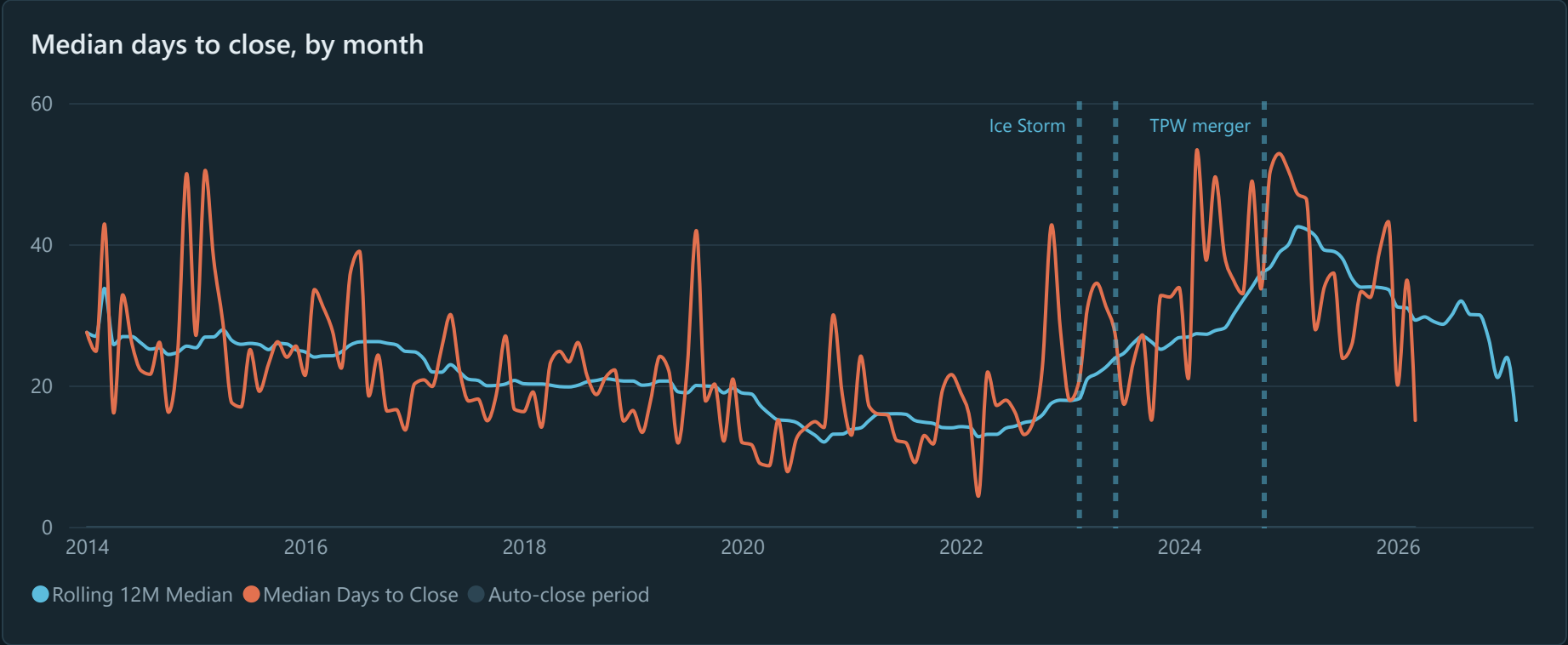
Traffic Sign New

Still open

0.48%

Requests in cohort (this service)

16.47K



## Reading this chart

Shown: Traffic Sign New, the single largest source of excess wait. Dotted lines mark the ice storm (Feb 2023), the CRM migration (Jun 2023), and the ATD/SBO/PWD merger into TPW (Oct 2024).

# Scored by the city's own due dates

Austin 311 | 2.5M service requests | 2014-2026 | Data: data.austintexas.gov

TPW Late Rate

5.27%

TPW On-Time Rate

94.73%

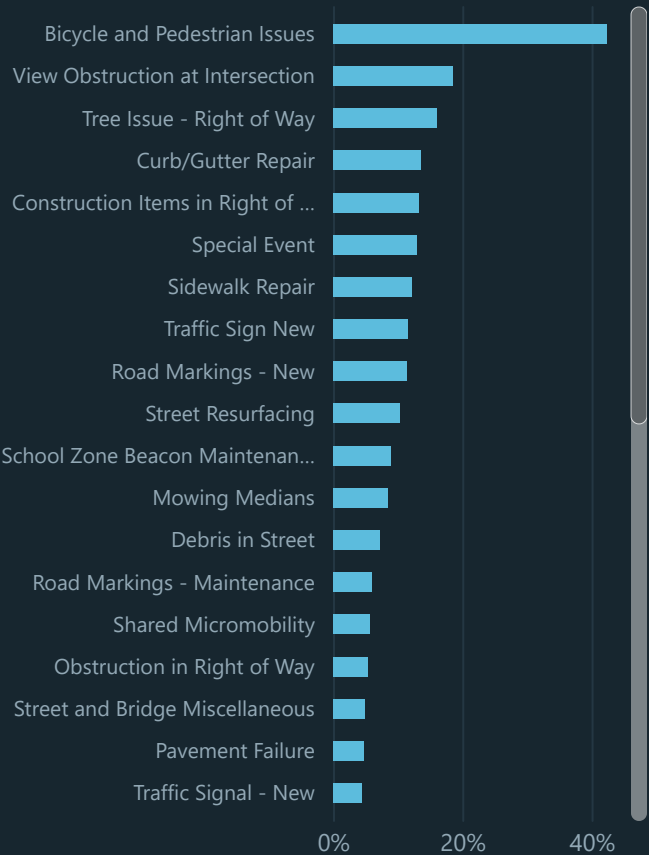
TPW Open & Overdue

60

## Service

All

## Share of requests closed late, by service



## Share of requests closed late, by month



| Service                          | City target (days) | Closed late | Requests |
|----------------------------------|--------------------|-------------|----------|
| Work Zone Activation             | 1                  | 0.05%       | 1907     |
| View Obstruction at Intersection | 21                 | 18.72%      | 2121     |
| Utility Cut Repair               | 71                 | 2.40%       | 1794     |
| Tree Issue - Right of Way        | 11                 | 31.35%      | 18722    |
| Traffic Signal Maintenance       | 43                 | 2.13%       | 36675    |
| Traffic Signal - New             | 64                 | 4.52%       | 2418     |
| Traffic Signal - Modification    | 64                 | 1.59%       | 2596     |
| Traffic Sign New                 | 71                 | 11.47%      | 6717     |
| Traffic Sian Maintenance         | 29                 | 1.33%       | 14405    |

## About these targets

The city sets a due date on every request but publishes no target table. These targets are reverse-engineered as the modal gap between created and due date, per service. They vary widely — 2 days for roadway spillage, 220 for guardrail repair. Where a service merges two departmental labels, the median target is shown. Services with fewer than 100 requests are excluded — small denominators produce unstable rates.

# Does the constructed method agree with the city's own scoring?

Austin 311 | 2.5M service requests | 2014-2026 | Data: data.austintexas.gov

Spearman  $\rho$

0.42

City late rate — degrading

12.8%

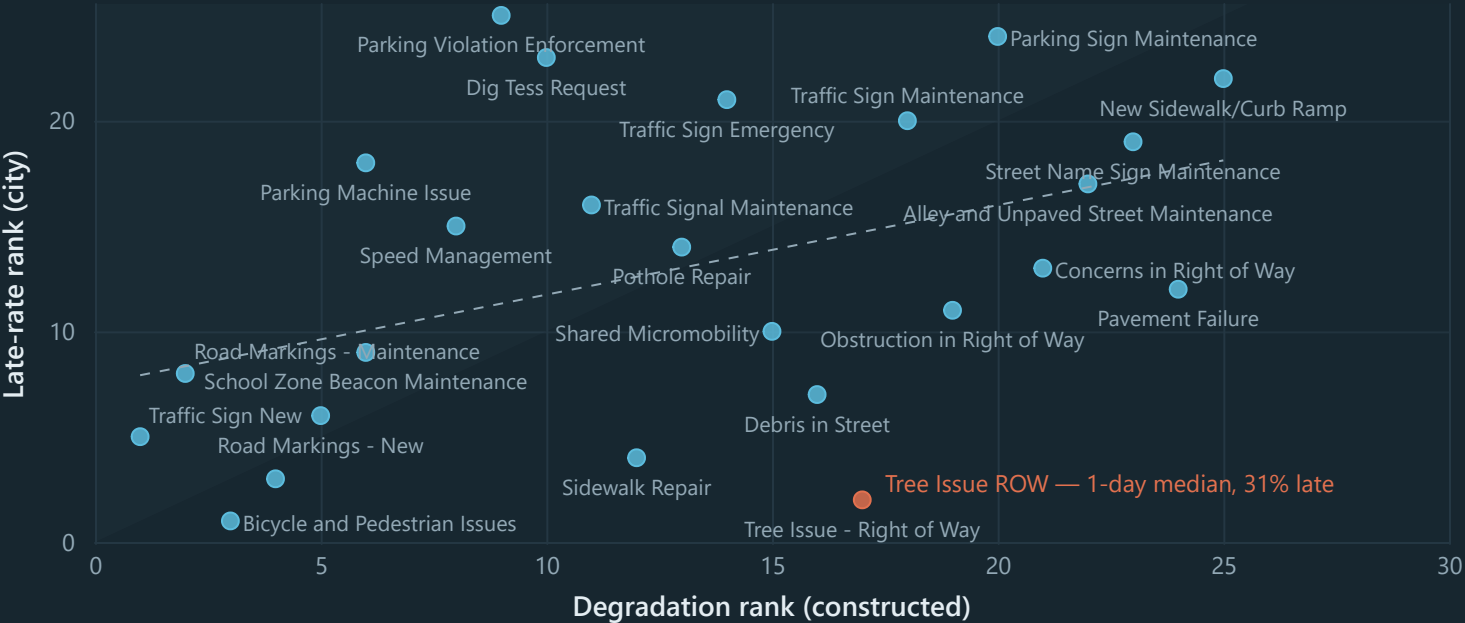
City late rate — improving

5.0%

Recent median over target (of 25)

2

Rank agreement: constructed method vs. city scoring

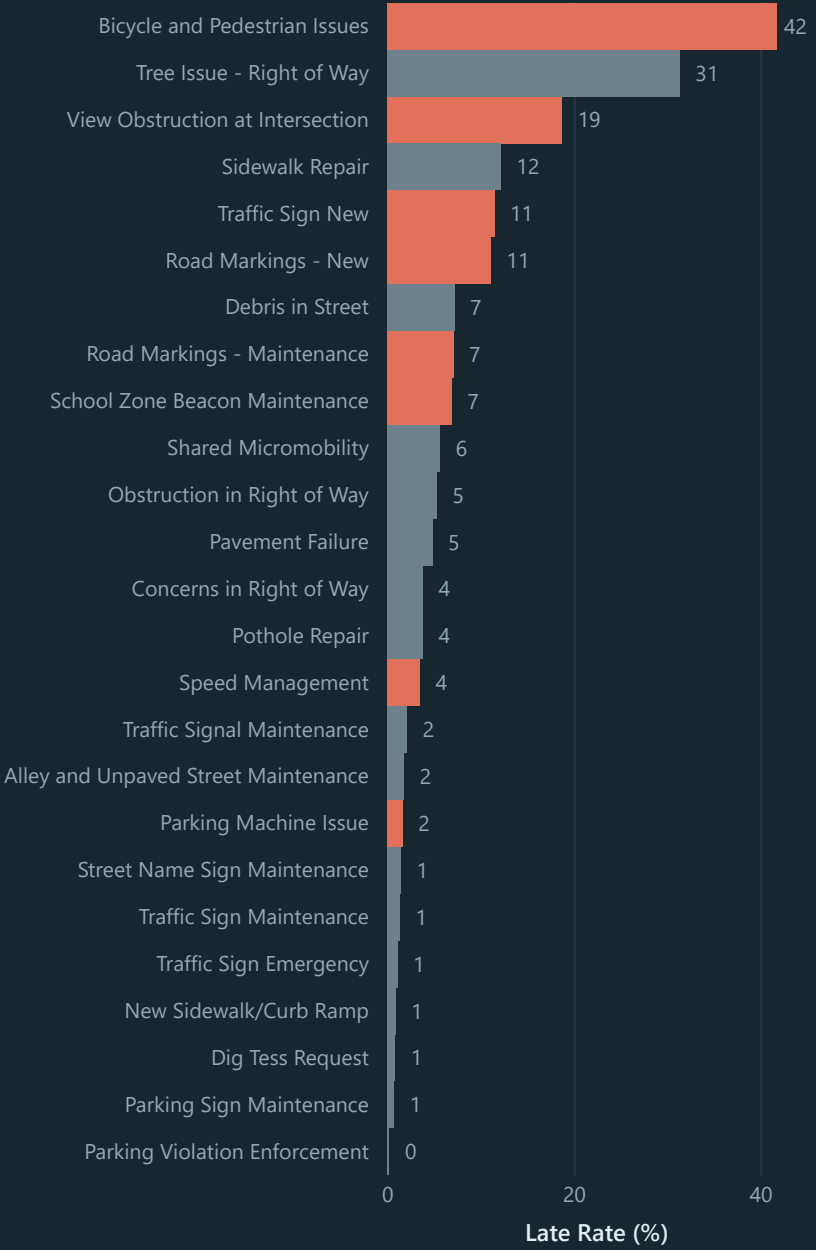


## Does the method hold up?

Across the 25 Transportation and Public Works services where the city publishes targets, the two methods agree on direction: services flagged as degrading average 12.8% late by the city's scoring, improving services 5.0%. Rank correlation  $\rho = 0.42$  — agreement on direction, not on order. Points above the diagonal are services the city scores worse than this method does; below, the reverse.

One disagreement is instructive. Tree Issue - Right of Way has a 1-day median but a 31% late rate — most close within a day, a third exceed the 11-day target. A median can't see a bimodal service; P90 would.

City late rate - highlighted where this method says "degrading"



# How this was built

Austin 311 | 2.5M service requests | 2014-2026 | Data: data.austintexas.gov

Raw Labels  
403

Canonical Services  
188

Requests in cohort  
2.34M

Mapping Basis  
All

| Raw label                                         | Canonical service             | Mapping basis       |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------|
| ACD - Billboard Complaint                         | Billboard Complaint           | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| ACE - Community Voices                            | Community Voices              | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| Animal In Vehicle                                 | Animal in Vehicle             | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| Animal Protection - Animal In Vehicle             | Animal in Vehicle             | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| Animal Protection - Animal Roadside Sales         | Animal Roadside Sales         | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| Animal Protection - Animal Trapped in Storm Drain | Animal Trapped in Storm Drain | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| Animal Protection - Coyote Complaints             | Coyote Complaints             | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| Animal Roadside Sales                             | Animal Roadside Sales         | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| Animal Trapped in Storm Drain                     | Animal Trapped in Storm Drain | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| APR (PARD) - Aquatic Maintenance                  | Aquatic Maintenance           | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| APR (PARD) - Commercial Use of Parkland           | Commercial Use of Parkland    | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |
| ATD - Bicycle & Pedestrian Issues                 | Bicycle and Pedestrian Issues | CONCURRENT_UNTESTED |

## How the numbers were made

Cohort: requests created > 180 days before the latest record; still-open ones counted at days-open-so-far (right-censoring). 50,038 requests closed in the same second they were created are excluded from resolution time. Labels merged only where the comparability test showed matching medians in overlap years; 8 labels split by that test. A 180-day auto-close detected in legacy Public Works and Watershed services (2016-2021) removes those service-years from the baseline. ARR's 2021-22 category rebuild makes pre/post definitions incomparable; those services are excluded from the 2015-2019 baseline. TPW flags ~7% duplicates; the citywide dataset does not, so citywide counts are likely inflated by a similar share.

| Date       | Event                      | What changed                                                                                                                        |
|------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10/25/2021 | ARR label retirement       | Austin Resource Recovery retires legacy labels (all ZZZ ARR labels end this day) and rebuilds its category scheme through Jun 2022. |
| 8/3/2022   | ATD prefix adoption        | Transportation labels gain the "ATD - " prefix; unprefixed originals end within days.                                               |
| 2/1/2023   | Winter Storm Mara          | Ice storm. ~63k requests in Feb 2023 vs ~20k monthly norm; storm debris collection dominates 2023 volume.                           |
| 6/2/2023   | CRM migration              | Legacy Public Works, Animal Services and Austin Code labels end within three days; successor labels begin.                          |
| 10/11/2024 | ATD/SBO/PWD merge into TPW | Transportation and Public Works formed. Every ATD/SBO/PWD label ends 10/07-10/13; TPW twin starts 10/08-10/14.                      |

## How each label was classified

